

How to quit strategically — Action Checklist

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FINANCIAL FOUNDATION

- ❑ **Financial Foundation:** List every fixed monthly expense exactly as it appears on your bank statements, including rent, utilities, insurance, debt payments, groceries, transportation, and phone to remove all estimation from your planning.
- ❑ **Financial Foundation:** Calculate your variable expenses by averaging your last three months of spending on dining, entertainment, subscriptions, shopping, and personal care to uncover hidden costs draining your budget.
- ❑ **Financial Foundation:** Add your survival number plus 15% buffer for unexpected costs like repairs and emergencies, because something will break and that number represents your true monthly floor to stay housed and fed.
- ❑ **Financial Foundation:** Perform a gap analysis by subtracting your survival number from your current income to understand exactly how much you need to cover monthly and how tight your budget will be.

EXIT PROFESSIONALLY

- ❑ **Exit Professionally:** Draft a brief, professional resignation letter that expresses appreciation and keeps your exit smooth, because the professional world is smaller than you think and references matter for your future.
- ❑ **Exit Professionally:** Schedule a direct conversation with your manager to deliver your resignation in person and express genuine thanks, because burning bridges you might need later turns a temporary problem into a permanent one.
- ❑ **Exit Professionally:** Keep your resignation timeline and future plans private from coworkers during your notice period, because mixed messages create resentment and colleagues may share information unpredictably.
- ❑ **Exit Professionally:** Leave your team with clear notes and accessible documentation for your responsibilities, because how you leave determines whether former colleagues become future allies or closed doors.

PLAN RECOVERY

- ☐ **Plan Recovery:** Schedule medical and mental health appointments immediately to address the physical symptoms of burnout, because chest tightness and frequent illness require professional support and monitoring.

 - ☐ **Plan Recovery:** Establish firm boundaries against work communications by not checking email or Slack and blocking recruiter outreach for at least the first month, because staying reachable prolongs recovery.

 - ☐ **Plan Recovery:** Create a daily routine that prioritizes sleep, nutrition, and movement to rebuild the energy reserves burnout depleted, because recovery requires intentional structure, not just rest.

 - ☐ **Plan Recovery:** Set a specific deadline when your runway ends and identify concrete next steps before that date arrives, because vague intentions about eventually finding work create avoidable panic.
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Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.